PITCH DECK | PEPPER ENTREPRENEUR IN RESIDENCE

# You called this an operating seat, not a strategy seat. I am running one right now, and I have already fixed a function nobody owned inside a public company.

*Founder-grade zero-to-one ownership, plus the operating discipline that makes performance legible in a day.*

- **Founder & CEO** of PriceKeel, building and running the business from zero
- **$700K+** margin recovered in 2 quarters, a function nobody owned at Sensata
- **Manual to AI-first:** converted a repetitive workflow to Claude agents at Applied Materials
- **8-person team** hired and managed across 8 client accounts, churn cut 50%
- **53% to 61%** distributor margin lift, a fix that held past the first cycle

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WHY THIS DECK EXISTS

# An Entrepreneur in Residence at Pepper gets handed two different problems: the one that does not exist yet, and the one that exists but has no owner.

### What the seat actually demands

A business line that needs to be rebuilt from zero has no backlog to inherit and no revenue model until someone writes one. That is a founder problem.

A function that is founder-led, ad-hoc or held together by heroics is the harder twin: the team and the process already half-exist, and the job is to step in, stabilize it, and hand it off clean.

Both need the same person to take a sentence instead of a brief, write the playbook, run it, prove it, then make it someone else's job.

### What I have already run, on both sides of that problem

At **PriceKeel**, I am building a product from inception right now: designed the guardrail engine and audit trail, set up the CRM, CPQ and deal-approval process from zero, and am running pilots while raising the first round.

At **Sensata**, I took a margin line with no real owner and built the Bleeders and Leakers program from scratch, then handed the reporting cadence to the team once it ran on its own.

Both took the same discipline: a number nobody had mapped, a team pointed at the highest-leverage fix, and a handoff that stuck.

**A founder who builds from zero and an operator who fixes an unowned function are not two different profiles. It is one operating pattern, run on both a founding problem and a fixing problem, which is exactly the range this seat asks for.**

THE REQ, MAPPED

# What the Founder's Office is asking for, and where the proof already sits.

## What the role covers

> *"A founder who built and ran something, or an operator who has owned Ops, Strategy, or Customer Success end to end and been accountable for the number."*

> *"Rebuild how work gets done with AI... identify the highest-leverage workflows and rebuild them AI-first."*

> *"Own customer outcomes where it counts. Get into live accounts, especially US enterprise, and fix retention and expansion mechanics at the root."*

## My Proof

**PriceKeel, founded and run today:** a product built from inception, with its own guardrail engine, audit trail, CRM, CPQ and deal-approval process, in pilots and raising its first round.

**Applied Materials:** converted a manual, repetitive analysis workflow into one run by agents built on Claude, the same AI-first rebuild this seat asks for.

**Sensata Bleeders and Leakers:** a margin line with no owner, now $700K+ recovered in 2 quarters and distributor margins lifted 53% to 61%.

**Pixis:** hired and directed an 8-person team across 8 client accounts, cutting churn 50% by fixing retention mechanics at the root.

THE SENSATA PROOF, IN DEPTH

# Bleeders and Leakers: find the number nobody mapped, fix it, make it hold without you.

Built as a BU-wide Power BI system covering 1,200 pricing opportunities against a $627M target across 3 regions, 4 product families and 20 product lines, with pipeline funnel, win rate and stage distribution by salesperson and product line.

## $433M

**Margin Opportunity Surfaced**

The dashboard's job: rank every underperforming line into a case leadership could act on, instead of chasing anecdotes account by account.

## $700K+

**Margin Recovered in 2 Quarters**

Closed through negotiations grounded in competitive data and documented customer willingness to pay, not across-the-board price hikes.

## 53% to 61%

**Distributor Margin Lift**

Repriced the channel logic itself, so the fix held past the first cycle instead of drifting back within a quarter.

The same seat carried AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes alongside senior executives, plus the leadership decks and OKR cadence that kept a multi-$100M business aligned, then promotion in 10 months once the program ran without daily oversight. The pattern: find the number, build the process around fixing it, then hand it off.

FIRST 30 DAYS

# What the first month as Pepper's Entrepreneur in Residence looks like.

WEEK 1

### Map what is unowned

Sit with the Founder and the COE team to find which business lines, functions and manual workflows are ad-hoc or held together by heroics, and get into live US enterprise accounts to hear retention and churn firsthand.

**Why first:** the strongest opportunity is usually visible in what already exists. Same move that started the Bleeders and Leakers program at Sensata.

WEEK 2-3

### Build the operating layer

Turn the highest-leverage workflow into a definition, a dashboard and a review cadence the Founder can see within 24 hours, and partner with product and engineering to rebuild the manual steps AI-first.

**Why now:** building the model with the real stakeholders in the room, not in a vacuum, is what made the 53% to 61% distributor gain stick.

WEEK 4

### Ship v1 and build the bench

Launch a working v1 rather than wait for a perfect plan, measure it against margin, CAC, retention or payback, then start hiring and coaching whoever takes it over next.

**Why this fast:** a function only counts as fixed once it can run without you in the room, and you have already moved to the next problem.

CLOSE

# You are hiring someone to take a sentence and come back with a plan. I have already done that founding a company, and I have already done it fixing a function nobody owned.

The founding half of the proof is live today: **PriceKeel**, built from inception, with its own guardrail engine, audit trail and deal-approval process, now in pilots while I raise the company's first round.

The unowned-function half is Sensata: **$700K+ recovered in 2 quarters** and distributor margins lifted **from 53% to 61%**, both handed off clean once they ran on their own. I am already converting manual work to AI-first at Applied Materials, and I already know what it takes to fix US-facing retention at the root from cutting client churn 50% at Pixis.

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